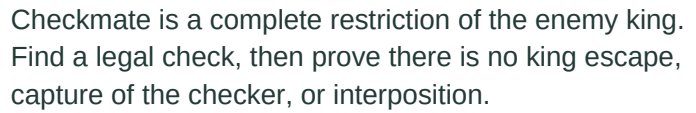


Mate in one

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES



Inspect the king's flight squares before choosing a check. A protected queen or a distant rook may cover the last escape in different ways.

The defending king is on e1. Geometrically undefended: rook on h1 and rook on a1. Check for tactical protection.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

9...exf2# Mate: pawn on f2 gives check; White has no legal reply.

The line ends in checkmate against the king on e1. Material gain is unnecessary once no legal defense exists.

Which piece delivers the final check, and why can the defender not continue? **Answer:** Pawn on f2. The king is in check and the position has zero legal replies.

A checking piece next to the king must be protected unless the king cannot capture it for another legal reason.